'Success depends upon previous preparation, and without such preparation there is sure to be failure.'

Confucius

CNEAP 401
Student Handbook: Semester 1, 2025

Electronics and Communication Engineering

Lancaster University College at Beijing Jiaotong University

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OVERALL AIMS OF MODULE

The masters's programme has been designed to widen the scope of your language-related academic skills required for successful study at Higher Education level. These are needed in approaches to academic research, the processes and conventions of academic writing, effective reading strategies, participation in seminars and the successful delivery of presentations, aa well as recording information accurately from lectures. During the course, the range and accuracy of your written and spoken academic English language will be further extended, to help you develop competence and confidence in a variety of academic contexts. Particular support will be offered to promote personal reflection on your learning and critical thinking to facilitate deeper insights and new perspectives.

On completion of the module, you will be better able to:

- Read with a large degree of independence, using effective reading strategies to identify the main lines of argument in academic texts and find specific information.
- Express opinions clearly, in spoken form, using a range of language and complex sentence forms, with appropriate style and register, whilst supporting those opinions with relevant sources of information
- Follow and take effective notes on the essentials of lectures, talks, reports and other forms of academic/professional presentations, which are propositionally and linguistically complex
- Write an essay systematically developing an argument with appropriate highlighting of significant points and relevant supporting information, and synthesing information and arguments from several relevant sources
- Understand the value of autonomy, reflective learning and ethical academic practices

Specific Learning outcomes

On completion of the module, you will be better able to:

- Critically evaluate sources to distinguish fact and opinion
- Skim academic texts for gist and scan for specific information, distinguishing between main points and supporting information, identifying sources of information in a text
- Deduce meaning and use strategies for understanding the meaning of unknown words, understanding implied meaning and author intent
- Identify relationships between ideas in a text
- Identify key information and make relevant notes

- Express opinions and agreement/disagreement or report on the views of others
- Initiate and maintain a discussion
- Deliver a structured presentation to an audience and respond to questions
- Develop fluency – connected speech, with clear pronunciation, stress and intonation
- Recognise lecture, presentation and essay structure
- Understand main ideas

- Identify specific information from presentations
- Recognise the importance of stress and intonation

- Understand essay questions
- Make notes from texts/lectures and paraphrase or summarise
- Organise your writing, with introductions and conclusions, paragraphing, sequencing ideas to produce a logical and effective coherent argument
- Write in an academic style, recognising and being able to use academic register
- Develop a greater understanding of the stages in drafting, editing and reviewing academic work

- Find, use or evaluate academic sources
- Manage your own time effectively
- Avoid plagiarism and maintain academic integrity
- Reflect on learning through collaboration, feedback and self-review
- Understand academic culture and register needed for study at tertiary level

CLASSES AND USING MOODLE

Your EAP 401 lessons will be taught in-class throughout the semester. However, your learning will often be asynchronous - you will study by yourself referring to the course materials uploaded to an online platform called Moodle). The majority of your learning will consist of self-guided independent study, which is normal at university. We will make considerable use of online resources though the learning platform, Moodle and communications will occur via Email, Moodle and WeChat. If you wish to refresh your memory about how to access Moodle, please watch the video in this ***link***. Remember that for Lancaster University College at Beijing Jiaotong University students the web address is ***modules.lucbjtu.ac.uk***

CN EAP 401 MOODLE PAGE

EAP 401's Moodle page will be central to your academic English studies at BJTU, as all the learning materials will be placed there, and we will refer to the page in almost every class. Currently, there are several sections giving important information on all areas of EAP, and more folders/documents/links will added as we progress in during the semester. The main headings and features of EAP 401 are shown below:

Welcome to EAP 401. This page will provide information and learning materials for our course. Feel free to contact me by email: m.warrick@lancaster.ac.uk

***Important documents:** This section contains the schedule for the semester, task/cover sheets required for submissions, as well as the descriptors used to evaluate your work.

- Assessments Schedule
- Writing Coursework Assignment Task Sheet
- EAP 401 Coursework Essay Cover Sheet
- Individual Presentation Task Sheet
- Writing Descriptors
- Speaking Descriptors

***Independent Research Portfolio**

This section provides the Independent Research Portfolio Guide and two essential booklets in which you should complete all your IRP assignments:

- EAP 401 Independent Research Portfolio Guide
- EAP 401 Subject Research and Learning Log Booklet
- EAP 401 Lesson Tasks Booklet

***Resources for Research and Independent Learning**

Here you will find useful documents to support your independent study and research. Discover how to access academic journals in the LU Library, improve your language skills by exploring the online independent study resources and become more effective MS Teams users:

- Introduction to Lancaster Library Resources
- Library Resources guide for students at Weihai
- LU Digital skills Microsoft Teams training
- Independent Research Resources
- Oxford Grammar EAP
- EAS: English for Academic Study

***Features of Academic Writing**

In this section you will find PPTs, documents and links to better inform you of all areas of academic English, with a focus on academic writing and vocabulary.

- Academic Vocabulary in Use
- Academic Collocations List (Pearson)
- Oxford Collocations Dictionary for Students of English
- Academic Writing: A Handbook for International Students (Bailey)
- Features of Academic Writing (PowerPoint Presentation)
- UEfAP - Features of Academic Writing
- Academic Phrasebank - General Language Functions

***Referencing and Avoiding Plagiarism**

This section gives links and documents that will enable you to reference your work using the Harvard System of Referencing.

- LU Library Harvard Referencing Guide
- Cite Them Right

Listening Practice Resources
Here are some links to different websites which you can enjoy and find useful to help develop your listening skills.

- BBC Six Minute English
- EAP Foundation Podcasts are audios that are 5 - 7 minutes in length and mostly focus on academic study skills advice.
- British Council > Learn English > Skills > Listening
- Cambridge Assessment > Learning English > Listening

Upload Area for students (Assessed Work)
You should upload all assessed or non-assessed work here, when requested to do so.

Weekly Materials for Students (Michael's class)
This area offers learning materials in weekly folders: Weeks 1-12

The next pages in the handbook contain all the most relevant documents listed in these two Moodle sections:

Important Documents +
Independent Research Portfolio

EAP 401 – Assessment Schedule (Autumn 2025)

WEEK #	w/c	Independent Research Portfolio (25%)				ESSAY 30% & PRESENTATION (15%)
		Class Topics/Lesson Tasks (R-W)		LEARNING LOGS	SUBJECT RESEARCH	
1	8-Sept-25	As instructed Introduction		*Self-evaluation* *Action plan*		
2	15-Sept-25	As instructed	Lesson Task 1: *Collocations (offline)*	*Reflection 1*		
3	22-Sept-25	As instructed				
	1-9-Oct-25	**National Holiday** **HW** *Lesson Task 2 online with time limit: Reading and evaluating a text*				
4	10-11 Oct	As instructed	Lesson Task 3: Paragraph *writing* (offline)	*Reflection 2*		
5	13-Oct-25	As instructed			*SR1*	Receive essay topic
6	20-Oct-25	As instructed	Lesson Task 4: *Support and referencing in a paragraph (offline)*	*Reflection 3*	*SR2*	
7	27-Oct-25	As instructed			*SR3*	
8	3-Nov-25	As instructed	Lesson Task 5: *Introduction and conclusion*	*Reflection 4*	*SR4*	
9	10-Nov-25	**PRACTICE EXAMS** **Reading (online)** **Listening (in class)**				Submit draft coursework essay

10	**17-Nov-25**	As instructed Lesson Task 6 *Creating a paragraph from notes*. *Reflection 5*	
11	**24-Nov-25**	As instructed	Submit finalised *IRP Lesson Tasks* and *IRP Subject Research and Learning Log* booklets
12	**1-Dec-25**	As instructed	FEEDBACK: 1st Draft of coursework essay
13	**8 -Dec-25**	**WRITING WEEK**	Submit draft presentation
14	**15-Dec-25**	**WRITING WORKSHOP**	FEEDBACK: draft presentation Submit final coursework essay Submit final presentation
15	**22-Dec-25**	**INDIVIDUAL PRESENTATIONS**	
16	**29-Dec-25**	**REVISION WEEK**	
17	**5-Jan-26**	**EXAM WEEK: Reading & Listening (15% + 15%)**	
18	**12-Jan-26**	**MARKING AND EXAM BOARD**	

Additional Notes:

*****w/c = week commencing (date weeks begins).*
** IRP submissions will generally be due on the Monday of the following week*

ASSESSMENT GRID

Key:

Coursework 55%	Exams 45%

Semester One (40% weighting of overall module mark)

Item	Activity	Description	Timing	Formative/ Summative	Weighting	Map to Outcomes
1	Essay	Coursework – Problem and Solution Essay (dependent on the masters degree on which the student is enrolled) - 1,200-word project report/essay	Weeks 6-12	Formative/ Summative	30%	Academic Writing: Be able to analyse, evaluate information, plan, draft and organise essays/reports in English, including referencing
2	Independent Research Portfolio	Coursework - Independent Research Portfolio with tasks aligned to discipline area	Weeks 1-12	Formative/ Summative	25%	Academic & Research Skills: Be able to manage own time effectively, to plan own learning strategies, and to be reflective, critical thinkers
3	Reading	Exam - Reading exam including assessment of referencing/citation skills	Exam Week	Summative	15%	Academic Reading: Be able to read effectively, in English, evaluate texts, understand implied meaning, identify key information, and use texts to support arguments
4	Listening	Exam - Listening exam with evaluative summary of lecture	Exam Week	Summative	15%	Academic Listening: Be able to extract main ideas from the lectures given in English, identify speakers' stance, understand meaning and take notes to support academic work
5	Presentation	Exam - Academic Presentation based on topic of the essay	Week 14/15	Formative/ Summative	15%	Academic Speaking: Be confident speakers of English in seminar situations, give presentations and support arguments

Key:

Coursework 55%	Exams 45%

Semester Two (60% weighting of overall module mark)

Item	Activity	Description	Timing	Formative/ Summative	Weighting	Map to Outcomes
1	Essay	Coursework - Cause and Effect Essay (dependent on the masters degree on which the student is enrolled) – 2,500-word project report/essay	Weeks 1-6	Formative/ Summative	30%	Academic Writing: Be able to analyse, evaluate information, plan, draft and organise essays/reports in English, including referencing
2	Independent Research Portfolio	Coursework - Independent Research Portfolio (including a literature review and research proposal)	Weeks 1-12	Formative/ Summative	25%	Academic & Research Skills: Be able to manage own time effectively, to plan own learning strategies, and to be reflective, critical thinkers
3	Reading	Exam - Reading exam including assessment of referencing/citation skills	Exam Week	Summative	15%	Academic Reading: Be able to read effectively, in English, evaluate texts, understand implied meaning, identify key information, and use texts to support arguments
4	Listening	Exam - Listening exam with evaluative summary of lecture	Exam Week	Summative	15%	Academic Listening: Be able to extract main ideas from the lectures given in English, identify speakers' stance, understand meaning and take notes to support academic work
5	Presentation	Exam - Academic Poster Presentation based on Research Proposal	Week 16	Formative/ Summative	15%	Academic Speaking: Be confident speakers of English in seminar situations, give presentations and support arguments

CNEAP 401 COURSEWORK ESSAY TASK SHEET: Semester 1, 2025

TOPIC

You are going to write a problem-solution essay on a topic in your own subject area.

You should examine a problem in your subject area and propose possible solutions supported by evidence. The solutions should then be evaluated. You must think of your own topic, your own title and conduct all the research yourself.

SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

- The coursework essay should be submitted as a Word document (No PDFs please).
- An appropriate academic style and structure should be used.
- Your essay must be original work which is not copied in whole or in part from another source.
- You should include a cover page at the beginning of the document, showing your Chinese name, English name, student number, class number and date.
- The essay should be 1000 - 1,200 words in length, excluding the cover page and reference list.
- The introduction must include background information, more specific information to show the importance of the topic and a thesis statement. You may wish to give a limitation or definition, and any relevant citation(s).
- You must include a suitable thesis statement which corresponds to the title of the assignment and paraphrases words where appropriate from the title.
- Each paragraph must have a suitable topic sentence.
- In the main body of the essay, you should explain the problem, indicate solutions and evaluate them.
- The essay must be written for an average, educated reader, not a specialist. Technical or specialist vocabulary must therefore be explained.
- The conclusion must summarise the problem(s), solutions and evaluation; you should offer a recommendation, prediction or implication at the end of your conclusion.
- You must paraphrase and summarise source material appropriately rather than quoting excessively. A small amount of quoting (no more than 10% of your text) is permitted.
- Plagiarism will be penalised.
- You should have at least 6 references to sources (*written or spoken in the English language*) in your reference list at the end of your essay. At least 4 of these references must be journal articles.
- Each reference in your reference list must have a corresponding citation, and vice-versa.

DO NOT

- Give subtitles in your essay
- Use any bullet points
- Plagiarize
- Write paragraphs containing only 2 or three sentences.
- Write a report; it must be an essay in the correct format

FORMATTING REQUIREMENTS

- 1.5 or 2.0 line spacing
- A space after each full stop and comma
- A page number inserted at the bottom of the page
- The font should be 12-point Times New Roman (preferred), Arial or Calibri.
- Black font colour

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Essay assigned: Week 5
- Draft submission: Week 9 (date to be confirmed) Ensure your draft submission is uploaded by 23:59 on the specified date.
- Final submission: Week 14 (date to be confirmed).
- Submit as a Word document on the EAP 401 Moodle page. Do not submit PDFs. SUBMISSIONS CANNOT BE ACCEPTED VIA WECHAT OR EMAIL
- Include the EAP 4O1 essay cover page at the beginning of the document, showing your student number, class number and date.
- This assignment is worth 30% of your final mark for the module.
- Penalties for late submission:

  - More than 24 hours late: 5%
  - More than 36 hours late: 10%

*IMPORTANT: Only those students who can provide a doctor's note may request exemption from penalties.

CNEAP401 Writing Assignment Descriptors

% Grade	Task Response	Coherence and cohesion	Language		Academic conventions
			Lexical resource	Grammatical range and accuracy	
100%	Fully addresses all parts of the task. Presents highly relevant, fully developed, and well-supported ideas. Sources are skillfully synthesised and clearly integrated into the discussion.	Writing is highly coherent and cohesive. Ideas are logically organised, with clear progression throughout. The thesis statement paraphrases the title effectively and outlines the main points with clarity. Paragraphs are focused and well-developed, using effective topic sentences. A wide range of cohesive devices are used naturally and accurately. The Reader can follow the argument effortlessly.	Lexical choices are consistently accurate, varied, and well suited to the academic context, showing sensitivity to tone and nuance. Subject-specific terminology is used appropriately and with confidence. Collocations are effective, contributing to clarity and sophistication of expression.	Demonstrates a wide and flexible range of grammatical structures, including accurate and varied use of both simple and complex sentences. Verb tenses, forms, and agreement are consistently correct. Word forms are used accurately and appropriately. Errors are rare and do not affect meaning.	Fully adheres to academic conventions, including accurate and consistent use of the Lancaster Harvard referencing style. In-text citations and reference list entries are correctly formatted. Paraphrasing is skillful and well-integrated, with clear source attribution. Academic register, structure, and presentation are highly effective and well suited to the task. Demonstrates excellent understanding of academic integrity.
90%	Addresses all parts of the task. Presents, extends, and supports main ideas clearly, though there may be occasional over-generalisations or minor lapses in focus. Sources are generally well synthesised and used appropriately.	Writing is coherent and mostly cohesive. Ideas are logically ordered and generally well developed. The thesis statement is relevant and mostly accurate in capturing the title and main points. Paragraphs are mostly focused and transitions are effective. Cohesive devices are used well, with only minor lapses in clarity or repetition. The text is easy to follow.	Uses a generally precise range of academic vocabulary accurately. Lexical choices are appropriate and support meaning well, with some evidence of flexibility and sophistication. Occasional imprecise word choices or collocational slips may occur, but these do not obscure meaning or weaken the overall clarity of the writing.	Uses a good range of grammatical structures, with mostly accurate control of simple and complex sentence forms. Occasional errors in verb forms, tense, or word formation may occur but do not impede meaning. Sentence variety is evident and generally well managed.	Mostly follows academic conventions. Lancaster Harvard citations are largely accurate, with only minor errors in formatting or punctuation. Paraphrasing is generally appropriate, and sources are attributed. Academic style and register are mostly suitable. Occasional lapses do not affect overall credibility.

80%	**Combination of elements from 70% and 90% bands**				
70%	Addresses all parts of the task, though some aspects may be covered more fully than others. Main ideas are generally relevant, but development may be uneven, and some points may lack clarity or sufficient support. Some attempt is made to synthesise and apply sources, though integration may be limited.	Writing is generally coherent, though there may be occasional lapses in logical flow or paragraph unity. The thesis statement attempts to paraphrase the title and outline the essay but may be vague or incomplete. Some cohesive devices are used effectively, but others may be repetitive, mechanical, or occasionally inappropriate. Ideas can be followed, but the reading experience is uneven.	Uses a sufficient range of vocabulary to convey meaning, though word choice is sometimes repetitive, imprecise, or awkward. There is an attempt to use academic vocabulary, but this is occasionally inaccurate or inappropriately applied. Lexical limitations may reduce clarity or force reliance on vague or general terms; meaning remains broadly understandable.	Uses a mix of simple and some complex sentence structures. Errors in grammar, verb forms, or word forms are noticeable but do not seriously hinder understanding. Attempts at variety are made, though sentence structure may be repetitive or occasionally awkward.	Adheres to academic conventions inconsistently. There may be errors or omissions in citation and referencing, including format issues with Lancaster Harvard style. Paraphrasing may be too close to the original or inconsistently attributed. Register is generally appropriate but may slip at times.
60%	**Combination of elements from 50% and 70% bands**				
50%	Addresses the task only partially. A position is presented, but development is unclear or inconsistent. Some main ideas are present, but they may be underdeveloped, repetitive, or only loosely related to the task. Source use is limited, and connections to the argument are often unclear or ineffective.	Coherence is limited. Ideas may be loosely organised, with weak paragraph structure or unclear progression. The thesis statement may be unclear or not well linked to the essay title. Cohesive devices are used inconsistently, and there may be overuse or underuse of linkers and reference words. The reader has to work to follow the arguments.	Vocabulary is limited and may rely heavily on everyday or informal language. Attempts to use academic vocabulary are inconsistent and often result in confusion or inappropriateness. Limited lexical range restricts the writer's ability to express complex ideas clearly.	Grammatical range is limited, with frequent reliance on simple sentence structures. Errors in tense, subject-verb agreement, and word or verb forms are common and may sometimes affect clarity. Attempts at complex structures may result in frequent mistakes.	Limited adherence to academic conventions. Referencing in Lancaster Harvard style is frequently inaccurate or incomplete. Paraphrasing may rely heavily on the original wording or lack proper attribution. Informal register or inconsistent structure may reduce academic credibility.

40%	**Combination of elements from 30% and 50% bands**				
30%	Responds to the task in a minimal or tangential way. Some ideas are presented, but they are difficult to identify, poorly developed, or largely irrelevant. Source use is very limited or inaccurate, and the relationship between sources and ideas is unclear.	Writing lacks coherence. Paragraphs are poorly structured or unrelated, and ideas do not follow a logical order. The thesis statement is weak or missing. Few cohesive devices are used, and those that may be incorrect or confusing. The reader struggles to understand how points connect.	Displays a very limited range of vocabulary, with frequent reliance on basic or repetitive language. There are frequent errors in word choice, including misuse of vocabulary. Attempts at academic expression are largely unsuccessful, and meaning is often unclear or obscured.	Very limited control of grammatical structures. Frequent and recurring errors in verb tenses, agreement, and word forms. Writing consists mostly of simple or fragmented sentences. Errors regularly interfere with meaning.	Weak control of academic conventions. Citations are often missing, incorrect, or not formatted in Lancaster Harvard style. Paraphrasing may be ineffective or show signs of patchwriting. Academic register is poorly controlled, with little attention to formal conventions. Concerns about academic integrity may arise. .
40%	**Combination of elements from 10% and 30% bands**				
10%	Does not adequately address the task. No clear position is presented. Ideas are mostly irrelevant, undeveloped, or absent. There is little or no evidence of appropriate source use.	Writing is incoherent and disjointed. There is no clear structure or logical progression. The thesis statement is missing or unrecognisable. Cohesive devices are largely absent or misused, resulting in confusion. The text fails to communicate meaning clearly or logically.	Frequent and severe errors in word choice, form, and usage consistently interfere with communication. Meaning is often unclear, distorted, or lost due to persistent lexical errors. Little to no evidence of control over academic language.	Grammatical control is minimal. Persistent and severe errors in sentence construction, verb usage, and word forms. Complex structures are rarely attempted or consistently incorrect. Meaning is often unclear or lost.	Minimal or no evidence of understanding academic conventions. Lancaster Harvard referencing is absent or wholly inaccurate. Paraphrasing is either not attempted or demonstrates a lack of source understanding. Academic register and structure are inappropriate. Serious concerns about academic integrity are likely.

Lancaster University College at Beijing Jiaotong University

CNEAP 401 PRESENTATION TASK SHEET: Semester 1, 2024

TOPIC

You are going to prepare and deliver an individual PowerPoint presentation on your essay topic. You should examine problems and solutions, and the solutions should be evaluated.

SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

- Each of you will present in front of a group of four other classmates. At the end of your presentation there will be time for questions. This is an important part of the presentation, so please ensure that you prepare adequately.

- You must arrive 10 minutes before the allocated period for your group.

- The presentation should last 5-6 minutes plus time for questions. At the end of 5 minutes, the examiner will indicate that 30 seconds are left. At 6 minutes and 30 seconds you will be asked to stop presenting, even if you have not finished. Presentations who present for less than 4 minutes will have a 5% reduction in their grade for the final presentation.

- Prepare 5–15 slides, including:
  - Slide 1: Name, student ID, and class
  - Slides 2–n: Introduction, main body, conclusion
  - Final slide: References (minimum of 6)

- Cite sources on relevant slides.

- Speak clearly and confidently, make eye contact with the audience and use visual aids effectively. Avoid reading directly from slides and practice using gestures to emphasize key points.

- Your presentation must be an original work, which is not copied in whole or in part from another source.

- The presentation is worth 15% of your final mark for the module.

- Failure to deliver the presentation will result in a mark of zero.

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Submit your slides as a PowerPoint file (.ppt or .pptx) via the EAP401 Moodle page; PDFs, WeChat, or email submissions are not accepted.

- Draft submission of PowerPoint slides due: Week 13 (date to be confirmed)
- Final submission due prior to Presentation Week 14 (date to be confirmed)
- Submit your slides as a PowerPoint file (.ppt or .pptx) via the EAP401 Moodle page; PDFs, WeChat, or email submissions are not accepted.
- Penalties for late final submission:
  - More than 24 hours late: 5% deduction
  - More than 36 hours late: 10% deduction

  ***Important Note**: Penalties apply unless valid documentation (e.g. doctor's note) is provided.

- Submit your slides as a PowerPoint file (.ppt or .pptx) via the EAP401 Moodle page; PDFs, WeChat, or email submissions are not accepted.

- The presentation accounts for 15% of your final mark for module CNEAP401.

Presentations will be delivered in Week 15 during class time.

CNEAP 401 Individual Presentation Descriptors

	Content	Delivery
100% (8.0+)	Fully covers the topic with consistently relevant and thoroughly supported ideas. Exemplary structure with clear and effective signposting throughout. Excellent use of and interaction with visual material, fully integrated into the presentation. Responds to audience questions with confidence, clarity, and insight.	Highly engaging delivery with skillful use of non-verbal communication (e.g. eye contact, gestures, posture). Fluent and consistently audible, with excellent control of volume, pace, and pausing for emphasis. Highly effective use of notes or cue cards, with minimal or no reliance on reading word for word from a script.
90% (7.0)	Covers the topic very well, with mostly relevant and well-supported ideas. Very well-organised structure with effective use of signposting. Strong use of and engagement with visual material. Handles questions clearly and competently.	Mostly engaging delivery with effective non-verbal communication and only minor lapses. Largely fluent and audible, with very good control of volume, pace, and pausing. Competent use of notes or cue cards, with only occasional dependence on reading word for word.
80%	**Combination of elements from 70% and 90% bands**	
70% (6.0)	Covers the topic well with generally relevant main ideas, though some may lack clarity or depth of support. Structure is clear and well organised, with effective signposting in most parts. Good use of visual material with some effective interaction. Responds to questions appropriately, though with occasional hesitation.	Some engaging delivery, though there may be occasional issues with non-verbal communication (e.g. limited eye contact or gesture). Generally fluent and audible, with reasonable control of volume, pace, and pausing. Mostly appropriate use of notes or cue cards, though there may be moments of reliance on reading word for word from a script.
60% (5.5)	Addresses the topic satisfactorily, though ideas may be uneven, underdeveloped, or only partially supported. Structure and signposting are adequate but may lack consistency or clarity. Visual material is used but may not be fully integrated or effectively referenced. Attempts to answer questions, though responses may be limited or lack fluency.	Satisfactory delivery overall, though more noticeable problems with non-verbal communication may affect engagement. Speech is sometimes fluent, but there may be inconsistencies in volume, speed, or pausing, and occasional issues with audibility. Basic use of notes or cue cards, but noticeable reliance on reading from a script may limit natural delivery.

50% (5.0)	Covers the topic only partially or unsatisfactorily, with few relevant ideas, most of which are insufficiently explained or supported. Structure and signposting are unclear or inconsistent. Limited or ineffective use of visual material, with minimal interaction. Attempts to answer questions, but communication issues hinder clarity.	Delivery is unsatisfactory, with significant issues in non-verbal communication (e.g. limited eye contact, minimal gesture, or distracting body language). Fluency is inconsistent, and use of volume, speed, and pausing is limited or ineffective; audibility may be poor at times. Use of notes or cue cards is unsatisfactory, with frequent reliance on word-for-word reading that reduces audience engagement.
40%	**Combination of elements from 50% and 30% bands**	
30% (4.0)	Main ideas are difficult to identify, and content is largely irrelevant or unsupported. Structure and signposting are very limited or poorly executed. Weak or inappropriate use of visual material, with little or no engagement. Struggles significantly to respond to questions, with frequent misunderstandings that affect overall	Delivery is inadequate, with major and persistent problems in non-verbal communication (e.g. lack of eye contact, rigid posture, or distracting gestures). There is little evidence of fluency, and volume, speed, or pausing are rarely used effectively; audibility issues may seriously hinder comprehension. Notes or cue cards are used in a very limited or ineffective way, with heavy and consistent reliance on reading word-for-word from a script.
20%	**Combination of elements from 30% and 10% bands**	
10% (3.0)	Covers the topic in a minimal or fragmented way, with ideas that are mostly irrelevant, unsupported, or poorly communicated. Little to no evidence of logical structure or signposting. Visual material is used ineffectively or not at all, with no meaningful interaction. Unable to respond to questions, or responses are confused and unclear, significantly impairing communication.	Very few discernible features of effective delivery are present. Severe problems in non-verbal communication (e.g. no eye contact, monotone delivery, or distracting behaviour) are evident throughout. Speech lacks any fluency, with almost no effective use of volume, pace, or pausing. Large portions may be inaudible or difficult to follow. There is little to no evidence of independent speaking, with total or near-total reliance on reading directly from a full script.

Document title: CNEAP 401 Individual Presentation Descriptors
Date: July 2025

EAP 401: INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO (IRP) GUIDE: GENERAL INFORMATION

Your Independent Research Portfolio is a central part of your studies and something you add to regularly as you develop your language and study skills throughout the course. Your IRP is comprised of two separate booklets:

1) Booklet 1: EAP 401: INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO: Subject Research and Learning Log
2) Booklet 2: EAP 401: INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO: Lesson Tasks

You will be given advice during the semester on how to complete an assignment in each booklet and when to submit.

BOOKLET 1:

SUBJECT RESEARCH (SR) (from Week 5-8)

- Your essay and presentation will be based on research (information YOU find out about the topic).
- This semester you will find at least 4 academic sources from academic journals related to your essay topic. Your tutor will advise you about the suitability of your sources of information.
- Articles can be found using OneSearch - LU Library's search tool, online and from the independent learning resources on Moodle.
- Evaluate each source by answering the questions indicated in the SR template
- Record at least 5 unfamiliar vocabulary or phrases that you encountered in the article; you should include any terms you may need to define in the essay. When you give an example in context, do not use the context from the journal article. Please include all the elements (a-e) in the example below:

Example:

1. Word: Explicit (adj.) /ɪkˈsplɪsɪt/
   - **a)** *Definition in English*: clear and easy to understand
   - **b)** *Word family*: explicitly (adv.); explicitness (n.)
   - **c)** *Collocations*: make / render explicit, fairly explicit
   - **d)** *Example in a sentence:* 'Darwin did not at first make explicit his view that human beings are descended from apelike ancestors.'
   - **e)** *Synonyms:* clear, obvious, straightforward, direct

LEARNING LOG (LL) Weeks 2 – 10)

- This will consist firstly of a self-evaluation and an action plan, followed by fortnightly reflections (starting in Week 2) on your learning; they should contain information about your study progress in a more informal way.

Finalized submission: Week 11

BOOKLET 2:

LESSON TASKS (LT)

- This part of your IRP is concerned with the work you complete for your classes
- To ensure you obtain a good IRP score, you should complete the tasks given
- All lesson tasks should be completed within the Lesson Tasks Booklet
- Lesson tasks will usually take place every two weeks and will be in-class and mainly off-line
- Only those students who can provide a doctor's note may request to complete the lesson task at another time. *Each lesson task must be submitted by the end of the class*

Lesson Task Submissions: Weeks: 2/4 (two tasks – one for h/w) /6/8/10

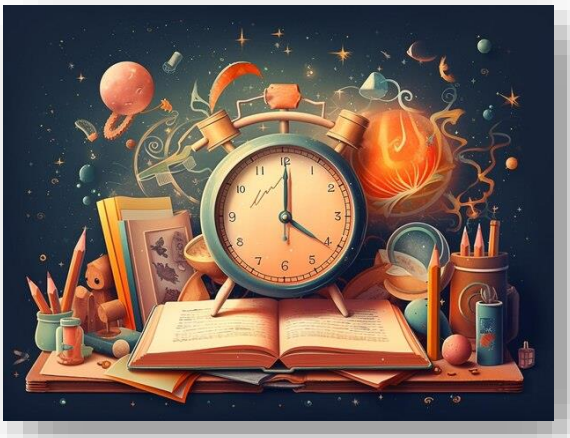
REFLECTIONS INSTRUCTION SHEET (from Week 2)

1. You will write fortnightly Reflections on your learning. Each of these should be at least 2 paragraphs in length (minimum 250 words in total) to reflect on your English language learning. This process will allow you to understand your strengths and weaknesses, and to improve your writing skills. If you are not sure about what you can include in your reflections, here are some questions to guide you:

- *What have you been doing in your classes? What thoughts and feelings do you have about classes?*
- *What have you been doing at home to improve your English? Were the results positive?*
- *What progress have you made since the previous week or two weeks?*
- *What problems have you encountered in your English learning? How did you solve them?*
- *What are your strengths and weaknesses? How can you use your strengths to the best of your ability? How can you improve your weaknesses?*
- *What are your objectives for next week(s)?*
- *What areas of writing/reading/listening/ do you feel you need to work on?*
- *What can you do to improve in these areas, either inside or outside the classroom?*

**NB Remember that thinking or reflecting on how you learn can improve the learning process.*

EAP 401 IRP SUBJECT RESEARCH (SR) INSTRUCTION SHEET (From Week 5)



Read steps 1-8 below. Having reviewed your Coursework Essay Task sheet:

1. Use the BJTU/LU library or another source to find a peer-reviewed/academic article which you consider useful for your essay.

2. Read the abstract (if there is one) to have an idea of the topic and how useful the article could be.

3. Make a note of the full reference details – record that information on the Article Evaluation form (see table on next pages):

4. Skim read the introduction and conclusion to get the general meaning.

5. Scan the whole article for specific information that you want to find.

6. Annotate the source text you have chosen by making notes in the margins and by highlighting or underlining key points. Add the annotated pages to the end of the Article evaluation below. Copy and paste this to the Subject Research and Learning Log booklet and upload to Moodle before the deadline.

7. You should record unfamiliar words/phrases; there is a section at the bottom of the template to note down new vocabulary.

8. Evaluate the article by answering the question(s) in the evaluation form on the next pages.

EAP 401 IRP SUBJECT RESEARCH: ARTICLE EVALUATION 1/2/3/4:

Task: You are going to write a problem-solution essay on a topic in your own subject area.

You should examine a problem in your subject area and propose possible solutions. The solutions should then be evaluated (i.e. you should explain which solution (or solutions) is (or are) best and why. Any solutions should be supported by evidence.

Choose a source you plan to use in your essay. Read it carefully and answer the following **eight questions** in 2-4 sentences. Your answers will help you to better understand and critically engage with your source.

Name(s) of author(s)			
Full title of article			
Full title of Journal/Book/newspaper			
Year Published		*Month*	
Volume Number		*Issue Number*	
Link			
REFERENCE 🔗			

1. *What is the main issue or problem addressed in this source?*
Summarise the problem clearly. Is it technical, practical, environmental, economic, or social?

2. *How does the source relate to the topic of your essay?*
Explain how the issue discussed in the source connects to the problem you are analysing.

3. What causes or contributing factors are identified in the source?
Does the source offer a technical explanation for the problem? Are any data or case studies used to support this?

4. *Does the source propose any solutions or responses to the problem?*
Briefly describe any solutions, technologies, or strategies that are introduced or evaluated.

5. *What theoretical or engineering concepts are discussed in the source?*
Mention any key ideas, principles, or models (e.g. signal processing, system design, error control, sustainability, etc.). How do these relate to your essay?

6. *Is the source credible and technically reliable?* Who is the author or publisher? Is the source peer-reviewed or produced by a recognised institution?

7. *How might you use this source in your essay?*
Will it help you explain the problem, support your solution, or evaluate other possible approaches?

8. *What are the strengths or limitations of this source for your assignment?*
Consider the depth of analysis, clarity, technical accuracy, or potential bias.

VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

Record at least 5 unfamiliar vocabulary or phrases that you encountered in the article; you should include any terms you may need to define in the essay. When you give an example in context, do not use the context from the journal article. Please include all the elements (a-e) in the example below:

Example:

2. Word: Explicit (adj.) /ɪkˈsplɪsɪt/

a) *Definition in English*: clear and easy to understand

b) *Word family*: explicitly (adv.): explicitness (n.)

c) *Collocations*: make / render explicit, fairly explicit

d) *Example in a sentence:* 'Darwin did not at first make explicit his view that human beings are descended from apelike ancestors.'

e) *Synonyms:* clear, obvious, straightforward, direct

3. ……

a) .... *etc*

EAP 401 INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO (IRP) MARKING DESCRIPTORS

100% Distinction	Evidence of considerable effort to complete the portfolio, reflecting a keen and enthusiastic student who has worked hard during the semester. Fully addresses all parts of the task with content that is relevant and fully-extended (where appropriate).
90%	Shows some features of 100% band and some features of 80% band
80% Merit	Evidence of a fair amount of effort to complete the portfolio, reflecting a student who has worked consistently hard during the semester. Addresses all parts of the task with content that is mostly relevant and extended (where appropriate).
70%	Shows some features of 80% band and some features of 60% band
60% **PASS**	The student has done what is required of them, reflecting someone who has done enough to get by. Addresses all parts of the task, though some parts may be more fully-covered than others, with content that is generally relevant and extended (where appropriate).
50%	Shows some features of 60% band and some features of 40% band
40%	The student has made some effort to complete the portfolio but has not done enough to meet the minimum requirements for a pass grade. Only partially addresses the task, with some gaps in content. Content is limited and not sufficiently extended.
30%	Shows some features of 40% band and some features of 20% band
20%	The student has made very little effort to complete the portfolio. Does not adequately address any part of the task, presenting little content, which is largely irrelevant.
10%	Shows some features of 10% band and some features of 0% band
0%	Does not address the task/No content is submitted.

PLAGIARISM EXPLAINED

Plagiarism is treated very seriously by BJTU and Lancaster University. If a student is found to have plagiarized, there can be serious consequences. If you extract ideas online, from paper books or from any other kind of resource to help you write an essay or dissertation, you must a) quote or b) paraphrase the original text; you must also include references to allow the reader to find the original source. If you do not cite or reference, or if you cite incorrectly and/or paraphrase poorly, you can be accused of plagiarism and your scores for work produced may be lowered (sometimes substantially) according to the degree of plagiarism.

Plagiarism involves the unacknowledged use of someone else's work and passing it off as if it were one's own. This may occur for many reasons. For example, the University recognises that students may submit plagiarised work because of poorly developed study skills (e.g. inadequate paraphrasing), and that some students, particularly those from different cultures and educational systems, may find UK academic referencing/acknowledgement systems and conventions unfamiliar.

However, some students do plagiarise deliberately, sometimes because they are unable or unwilling to do the required work, and with the intent to deceive and gain academic benefit. This is a conscious, pre-meditated form of cheating and is regarded as a serious breach of the core values of the University and damaging to the reputation of the University and its programmes. There is a Plagiarism Framework on the webpage below:

https://www.lancaster.ac.uk/academic-standards-and-quality/regulations-policies-and-committees/principles-policies-and-guidelines/plagiarism-framework/

This framework explains how the issues of plagiarism are to be handled and defines how possible cases of plagiarism will be dealt with under Lancaster University's regulations and procedures contained in the chapter on Academic Malpractice in the Manual of Academic Regulations and Procedures (MARP). This framework applies equally to all assessments submitted by students for examination by the University in all academic taught programmes (UG and PGT) and also to formally assessed taught elements of PGR programme.

Any work you upload to Moodle will be checked by computer software called *Turnitin*. This software is designed to check your work to make sure that you have not copied the content from another source. You will learn more about how to avoid plagiarism and you will receive guidance on how to use the information that you read from sources in an appropriate way in your writing.